Most quality attributes are limited to just a system/product level. Still, quality attributes are so important from the company strategy perspective that they are established at the level of the governance team or top management.

Constraints

Constraints are usually independent of us and are imposed by a governance body or top management. You can divide constraints into the following categories:

- Time and budget constraints
- Technology constraints
- People and organizational constraints

Time and budget constraints are self-explanatory, and we believe everybody is familiar with them. An example of such a constraint is a deadline for delivering solutions. A widespread example of technology constraints is how an organization hosts its applications. It might be an on-premises solution versus one of the cloud vendors like Google, AWS, or Azure. Last, people and organizational constraints can be the technology stack of your solution because of the limited skills of development teams (e.g., you can use only Java as a general-purpose programming language on the backend).

Principles

If your organization has strong technical leadership or some kind of architecture or data governing body, an explicit list of *principles* should drive your design decision. You can see examples of such principles in table 9.2.

Table 9.2 Guiding principles

Name	Description	Rationale	Implications